



FADE THE CHALK

RACE 13

Belmont Park · Saturday, June 6, 2026

The Belmont Stakes (G1) · 1¼ Miles, Dirt · 3YO · 9-Horse Field · \$2,000,000

“Three speed horses will cook each other at a mile and a quarter. The favorite profits — but so does a richer closer at five-to-one.”

Qualify

Nine live runners contest the championship, and it is not a maiden. The favorite, #4 Renegade at 9/5, breaks from post 4 in the middle (not inside, so the inside-traffic rule does not fire). With four horses at 5/1, the race behind the favorite is wide open and competitive.

The Field & Running Styles

#	Horse	Odds	Style	Basis
1	Vitruvian Man	20/1	P	Lightly raced; stalks
2	Powershift	12/1	P	Stalks; makes one run
3	Chief Wallabee	5/1	E/P	Forward; presses (Kentucky Derby winner)

#	Horse	Odds	Style	Basis
4	Renegade (fave)	9/5	P	Classic Pletcher stalker; chases and improves
5	Ottinho	19/1	P	Brown barn; stalks
6	Winnebago (Ire)	12/1	P/S	Closer (Clement); rallies inside
7	Commandment	5/1	E	Front-runner; wants the lead
8	Emerging Market	5/1	E	Forward speed; chased inside
9	Golden Tempo	5/1	P	Closes from well behind

Pace Map & Favorite Assessment

Three want the front — #7 Commandment and #8 Emerging Market (both E) with #3 Chief Wallabee (E/P) pressing. At a mile and a quarter, that pace pressure is significant and tends to fold the front-runners late. The closers and well-placed stalkers inherit the race — which, again, is about *who* the duel helps.

Favorite assessment: #4 Renegade is PROTECTED. Like the Woody Stephens, this looks like a fade but isn't: there is a pace duel, but the favorite is a stalker who sits just off it and pounces — the meltdown sets up for him, not against him. Pletcher and Prat, \$1.95M earned, a Beyer of 98, and a clean middle draw round out an ideal stalking trip at the classic distance. No trigger fires; he stays in the exotics as the likely winner.

Money signals & filters: no notable late tote drops on the non-favorites (S2), no layoff or troubled-trip flags.

Signal Scoring

#	Horse	Odds	Signals Fired	Score
1	Vitruvian Man	20/1	—	0
2	Powershift	12/1	B16 (recent life)	1
3	Chief Wallabee	5/1	B16 (recent life — won the Kentucky Derby)	1
4	Renegade	9/5	FAVE. PROTECTED — stalker who profits from the pace duel; ideal trip	EXOTICS

#	Horse	Odds	Signals Fired	Score
5	Ottinho	19/1	—	0
6	Winnebago (Ire)	12/1	— international, limited US form	0
7	Commandment	5/1	B16 (recent life) — but E in the pace duel = risky	1
8	Emerging Market	5/1	B6 (Beyer 97, co-best non-fave) · B16 — but speed in the duel, downgraded for pace risk	2
9	Golden Tempo	5/1	B9 (earnings leader, \$3.4M — towering) · B16; closer profits from the collapse	2

Wagering Plan

Win selection: #8 Emerging Market and #9 Golden Tempo both score 2. The tiebreaker goes on pace fit — Emerging Market is an E type likely to be cooked in the duel, while Golden Tempo is a closer who profits from it. Golden Tempo is the clear pick.

Win — Golden Tempo (#9) · 5/1 · \$50 · Conviction: MODERATE

The richest horse in the field by far (\$3.4M), proven at the classic distance, with a closing style that is tailor-made for a mile-and-a-quarter pace meltdown. At 5/1 against a 9/5 favorite, he is the one most likely to outfinish the chalk — and clears the value floor comfortably.

Exacta Box — #9 / #3 / #4 / #8 · \$5 unit (\$60) · favorite INCLUDED

The favorite is protected, so he stays in as the likely winner. The box pairs the closer (#9) with Chief Wallabee (#3, the Derby winner — experienced speed that can survive a route duel), Renegade (#4), and Emerging Market (#8), the field-best Beyer if he manages to rate.

Trifecta Box — add Commandment (#9 / #3 / #4 / #8 / #7) · \$1 unit (\$60)

Commandment is added as the speed that could wire it if the pace is milder than projected. The five-horse trifecta clears the minimum and carries every exacta horse through.

Bet	Amount
Win	\$50
Exacta Box (4)	\$60
Trifecta Box (5)	\$60
Total Outlay	\$170

Synthesis

Pace Story

Commandment and Emerging Market duel for the lead with Chief Wallabee pressing from outside. At a mile and a quarter, that pressure is significant. Renegade stalks from post 4 and Golden Tempo closes from further back; the pace sets up for the closers, though the favorite is well-placed to benefit too.

Honest Assessment

Moderate conviction. Four horses at 5/1 make the race behind the favorite wide open — it could go several ways. Golden Tempo is the value: the richest, the proven router, and the closer the pace most rewards. The favorite stays in the exotics as the probable winner.

Predicted Finish

Pos	Horse	Why
1	#4 Renegade	Class; Pletcher/Prat; ideal stalking trip
2	#9 Golden Tempo	\$3.4M earner; closes into the tired pace
3	#3 Chief Wallabee	Derby winner; experienced enough to hang
4	#7 Commandment	Sets the pace; fades but holds for fourth

Signals fired: B6, B9, B16. Value-driven race analysis — never bet the favorite to win. Prepared June 6, 2026
· live-odds edition.